

27 common signs of AI writing

As of today, it lists **more than 27** common signs. Earlier snapshots circulated as "27 signs." Below is a clean pull of the **current** signs, grouped as Wikipedia presents them. Source at the end.

Language & tone

1. Undue emphasis on symbolism or importance
2. Promotional language
3. Editorializing
4. Overuse of certain conjunctions
5. Section summaries that restate the obvious
6. Outline-like "challenges and future prospects" conclusions
7. Negative parallelisms
8. Rule of three patterns
9. Superficial analyses
10. Vague attribution of opinions
11. "False range" constructions (e.g., "from X to Y" suggesting breadth that is not there) ([Wikipedia](#))

Style

1. Title case in section headings
2. Excessive boldface
3. List-heavy drafting where prose would fit better
4. Emoji usage
5. Overuse of em dashes
6. Curly quotes and apostrophes where straight quotes are expected

7. "Letter-like" writing (notes-to-reader tone) ([Wikipedia](#))

Communication aimed at the user

1. Collaborative chatter ("let's explore...", "in this article we will...")
2. "Knowledge-cutoff" disclaimers or speculation about missing sources
3. Prompt refusals or meta-talk about capabilities
4. Phrasal templates or placeholder text left in the draft ([Wikipedia](#))

Markup quirks

1. Markdown syntax pasted into wikitext
2. Broken wikitext that creates numbered lists or headings by accident
3. Non-Wikipedia citation artifacts like `contentReference` , `oaicite` , `oai_citation`
4. Non-Wikipedia metadata like `attribution` or `attributableIndex`
5. Tracker parameters such as `utm_source=` left in links
6. Named references declared but never used
7. Non-existent categories added to the page ([Wikipedia](#))

Citations

1. Broken external links
2. Invalid DOI or ISBN entries
3. Incorrect or unconventional reference usage ([Wikipedia](#))

Miscellaneous

1. Abrupt cut-offs mid-sentence or mid-section
2. Style or dialect shifts within the same page
3. Text age that oddly predates ChatGPT yet shows LLM patterns
4. Overly long, verbose edit summaries revealing prompt-like language ([Wikipedia](#))

